

hyperion

2 COMPACT DISCS FOR THE PRICE OF ONE

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Monteverdi
SECOND
VESPERS
FOR THE FEAST OF SANTA BARBARA
THE SIXTEEN
HARRY CHRISTOPHERS *conductor*



MONTVERDI'S 1610 VESPERS contains some of the best-known music of the entire Baroque period, but the composer appears to have left no indication of the occasion for which the pieces were composed. Indeed, it would seem likely that the pieces were written individually, and only form a group in our minds because they were eventually published as such. The one thing we do know is that the Vespers music was written while Monteverdi was in the service of the Duke of Mantua; it was published during a period in which he felt undervalued by the Gonzaga family, and was looking for employment elsewhere.

The reconstruction presented here is the result of a new hypothesis regarding the circumstances of composition, which I argued in full in an article in *Early Music* published in August 1987. Some aspects of the arrangement of the Vespers volume had always seemed rather curious to me, and I began to investigate, bearing in mind the situation in Mantua during Monteverdi's activity there. The inclusion of a setting of *Duo Seraphim* had always appeared particularly problematic: its text begins with a description of the Seraphim calling to one another around the throne of God, and ends with a firm statement of faith in the doctrine of the Trinity. Clearly the statement of this dogma is of fundamental importance to Christian thought, but it has little to do with the celebration of Feasts of the Virgin Mary. The Trinitarian text of that item had always appeared to be at odds with the title-page of the publication.

This made me wonder if the dedication of the 1610 publication to the Virgin may not fully express the original intention behind the music contained in the volume. Italian religious institutions tended to put more emphasis on the celebration of local saints and festivals than on those observances which were the common property of the whole Church. In Mantua, and particularly in the Gonzaga household where Monteverdi was employed, one saint dominated all the others—Santa Barbara; she was the patron of the Gonzaga family, and the basilica within the grounds of the palace was dedicated to her honour. Because of her rare beauty Barbara had been

imprisoned in a tower during her father's absence; she was converted to Christianity, and asked the builders who were working on her tower to add a third window in honour of the Trinity. Eventually she was martyred on account of her Christian faith. The text of *Duo Seraphim* with its strong Trinitarian emphasis ties in well with the celebration of the Feast of Santa Barbara, and indeed two of the antiphons sung at the basilica at Second Vespers on her day refer to the doctrine of the Trinity.

Each year her festival on 4 December was celebrated in the ducal basilica with great solemnity. The preface to a collection of music published in 1613 by a later Mantuan composer, Amante Franzoni, indicates that instrumental music was heard regularly on that day. It would have been a celebration of great political importance to the Gonzaga family, for in honouring their patron worthily they were drawing attention to their own prestige as a ruling dynasty. Franzoni's collection of 1613 contains a setting of *Duo Seraphim* for use on the Feast-day, showing that the text had a definite place in the musical settings performed during the celebrations. It would seem strange if the most elaborate music to emerge from the Mantuan court in that period were not employed on the Feast of the saint who was venerated more highly than any other.

The service would have opened with an adaptation of the toccata from *L'Orfeo*, a fanfare which seems to have possessed special ceremonial importance for the Gonzaga family. Thus the ruling family would have heard the opening call for God's help sung to music which symbolized their power as they assembled for Vespers to honour the saint whom they regarded as their protectress.

An examination of the liturgy peculiar to the ducal basilica reveals that the psalms used at Second Vespers of Santa Barbara correspond exactly to those set by Monteverdi. Given the lack of evidence it is pointless to claim that the psalms were all composed as a cycle for one particular celebration. Indeed, they could well have been written over the course of a longer period to add grandeur to the celebrations by standing

in place of the normal chant of the liturgy. The special liturgy of the ducal basilica was the product of Counter-Reformation conservatism, and it could well be that Monteverdi took the unusual step of including chants in the psalm settings in order to preserve the traditional ethos of worship there.

The *Song of Songs* texts *Pulchra es* and *Nigra sum* are applicable not only to Feasts of the Virgin, but also to celebrations of any female saint; they could equally well have been associated with the Feast of Santa Barbara or with the Virgin Mary. The only additional items (beyond those appropriate for Santa Barbara) are *Audi caelum* and *Ave maris stella*. *Ave maris stella* uses the Roman and not the Santa Barbara form of the chant, and it was not therefore expressly intended for the ducal basilica; it has been included in this recording for the sake of completely representing the 1610 publication of the Vespers music.

The *Sonata sopra Sancta Maria* might be thought to raise some problems, but there is evidence to show that liturgical pieces of this nature were frequently adapted to include the name of the saint whose Feast it was. In similar examples the name of the saint is left blank, or its place is marked with an 'N', and appropriate rubrics supplied (for instance, 'This motet is appropriate for any saint, male or female'). Perhaps Monteverdi's sonata was originally composed with Mary in mind, but contemporary usage shows that the substitution of one saint for another was standard practice. In this reconstruction the name of Barbara replaces that of Mary, and the familiar rhythm has been adjusted to take account of this.

Two short instrumental sonatas have been employed as antiphon substitutes. These are taken from a manuscript compiled by the Mantuan musician Giovanni Amigone in 1613. It is not certain that Amigone himself was the composer, but the pieces can certainly be numbered amongst the earliest solo sonatas for a treble instrument and continuo.

We know that Monteverdi had no official position in the ducal basilica, which employed its own staff and was independent from the secular musical establishment of the court. This

separation of function surely accounts for the meagre amount of church music which Monteverdi produced during his time in the service of the Gonzaga family. During the years following *L'Orfeo* the ducal church underwent an unsettled period when the *maestro* was ill, and a satisfactory replacement was not found. The family may well have overridden their own administrative structures during such a period by commissioning their most famous musician to help maintain the standard of music in the chapel. Indeed, the mention of 'princely chapels' on the title-page of the 1610 publication could even be regarded as misleading if the works had never been performed in the chapel attached to the palace where he had worked for so long.

Why did Monteverdi decide to publish a Vespers 'della Beata Vergine', rather than alluding to the works' origins in a dedication to Santa Barbara, if her Feast really lay behind the composition? By the time Monteverdi published the 1610 volume his relationship with the Gonzaga dynasty had been soured. He was looking for a job elsewhere and had to prove his competence as a composer. If Monteverdi had published a volume of music intended for Vespers of Santa Barbara he would have created little interest: no other institution celebrated the Feast as lavishly, and moreover he would have been adding enormously to the prestige of the family who had treated him unjustly. So much of the music was interchangeable that it was no problem for Monteverdi to publish the music with a Marian dedication: the number of religious institutions dedicated to the Virgin would have ensured a good market for the music. But Monteverdi does use his Gonzaga connection to his own advantage on the title-page of the volume: here he states that the music is appropriate for 'Sacella sive Principum Cubicula'—the chapels and chambers of princes. The works which comprise the volume may well owe their origins to celebrations in honour of the saint to whom the princely chapel in Mantua was dedicated—Santa Barbara.

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[2] Deus in adiutorium meum intende.

Domine ad adiuvandum me festina.
Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio,
et nunc et semper et in saecula saeculorum. Amen. Alleluia.

[3] Angelicam vitam eligens. Beata Barbara

suum corpus immaculatum Domino consecravisti. Alleluia.

[4] Dixit Dominus Domino meo: Sede a dextris meis:

Donec ponam inimicos tuos, scabellum pedum tuorum.
Virgam virtutis tuae emittet Dominus ex Sion:
dominare in medio inimicorum tuorum.
Tecum principium in die virtutis tuae
in splendoribus sanctorum:
ex utero ante luciferum genui te.
Iuravit Dominus, et non poenitebit eum:
Tu es sacerdos in aeternum secundum ordinem Melchisedech.
Dominus a dextris tuis
confregit in die irae suae reges.
Iudicabit in nationibus,
implebit ruinas:
conquassabit capita in terra multorum.
De torrente in via bibet:
propterea exaltabit caput.
Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

[5] Pulchra es, amica mea, suavis et decora filia Jerusalem.

Pulchra es, amica mea, suavis et decora sicut Jerusalem,
terribilis ut castrorum acies ordinata.
Averte oculos tuos a me quia ipsi me volare fecerunt.

[6] In Dei orto sata nunc piorum frequentiam

suavissimo odore conspergit. Alleluia.

[7] Laudate pueri Dominum: laudate nomen Domini.

Sit nomen Domini benedictum,
ex hoc nunc, et usque in saeculum.
A solis ortu usque ad occasum,

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

*Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning,
is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen. Alleluia.*

*The Blessed Barbara chose the life of the spirit,
and thus dedicated her body spotless to the Lord. Alleluia.*

*The Lord said unto my Lord: 'Sit thou on my right hand,
until I make thine enemies thy footstool.'*

*The Lord shall send the rod of thy power out of Sion:
be thou ruler, even in the midst among thine enemies.*

*In the day of thy power shall the people
offer thee free-will offerings with holy worship:
the dew of thy birth is of the womb of the morning.*

*The Lord sware and will not repent:
'Thou art a Priest for ever after the order of Melchisedech.'*

*The Lord upon thy right hand
shall wound even kings in the day of His wrath.*

*He shall judge among the heathen:
He shall fill the places with dead bodies:*

*and smite in sunder the heads of many countries.
He shall drink of the brook in the way:
therefore shall He lift up His head.*

*Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.*

Thou art fair, my love, beautiful, comely, daughter of Jerusalem.

*Thou art fair, my love, beautiful and comely as Jerusalem,
terrible as an army set in array.*

Turn thine eyes from me, for they have made me flee away.

*Like a flower planted in the garden of God, she now pours on
the gathering of the faithful her most delightful scent. Alleluia.*

Praise the Lord, ye servants: O praise the name of the Lord.

Blessed be the name of the Lord:

from this time forth for evermore.

The Lord's name is praised: from the rising

laudabile nomen Domini.
Excelsus super omnes gentes Dominus
et super caelos gloria eius.

Quis sicut Dominus Deus noster,
qui in altis habitat, et humilia
respicit in caelo et in terra?

Suscitans a terre inopem,
et de stercore engens pauperem:
Ut collocet eum cum principibus
cum principibus populi sui.

Qui habitare facit sterilem in domo,
matrem filiorum laetantem.

Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

- 9 Paterni oblita amoris** repudiatis falsis diis,
se ad Dei Veri cultum convertit. Alleluia.

- 10 Laetatus sum in his,** quae dicta sunt mihi:
In domum Domini ibimus.
Stantes erant pedes nostri, in atriis tuis Jerusalem.
Jerusalem, quae aedificatur ut civitas:
cuius participatio eius in idipsum.
Illuc enim ascenderunt tribus, tribus Domini:
testimonium Israel ad confitendum nomini Domini.
Quia illic sederunt sedes in iudicio,
sedes super domum David.
Rogate quae ad pacem sunt Jerusalem:
et abundantia diligentibus te.
Fiat pax in virtute tua:
et abundantia in turribus tuis.
Propter fratres meos et proximos meos,
loquebur pacem de te:
Propter domum Domini Dei nostri,
quaesivi bona tibi.

Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

- 11 Nigra sum, sed formosa,** filiae Jerusalem.
Ideo dilexit me rex et introduxit me in cubiculum suum

*up of the sun unto the going down of the same.
The Lord is high above all heathen
and His glory above the heavens.
Who is like unto the Lord our God,
that has His dwelling so high: and yet humbles
himself to behold the things in heaven and earth?
He takes up the simple out of the dust:
and lifts the poor out of the mire:
That He may set him with princes,
even with the princes of His people.
He makes the barren woman to keep house,
and to be a joyful mother of children.*

*Glory to be the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.*

*Setting aside her love for her father she rejected false gods,
and turned to the worship of the true God. Alleluia.*

*I was glad when they said unto me:
'We will go into the house of the Lord.'
Our feet shall stand in thy gates, O Jerusalem,
Jerusalem is built as a city:
that is at unity in itself.
For thither the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord:
to testify to Israel, to give thanks to the Lord's name.
For there is the seat of judgement:
even the seat of the house of David.
O pray for the peace of Jerusalem:
they shall prosper that love thee.
Peace be within thy walls:
and plenteousness within thy palaces.
For my brethren and companions' sakes,
I will wish thee prosperity.
Because of the house of the Lord our God
I will seek to do thee good.*

*Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.*

*I am black, but comely, O ye daughters of Jerusalem:
Therefore the King loved me and brought me into his chambers,*

et dixit mihi: Surge, amica mea, et veni.
Iam hiems transit, imber abiit et recessit,
flores apparuerunt in terro nostro. Tempus putationis advenit.

12 In Sanctae Trinitatis confessione perseverans,
plagis omnibus Dei misericordia liberatur. Alleluia.

13 Nisi Dominus aedificaverit domum,
in vanum laboraverunt qui aedificant eam.
Nisi Dominus custodierit civitatem, frustra vigilat qui custodit eam.
Vanum est vobis ante lucem surgere:
surgite postquam sederitis, qui manducatis panem doloris.
Cum dederit dilectis suis somnum:
ecce haereditas Domini filii:
merces, fructus ventris.
Sicut sagittae in manu potentis: ita filii excussorum.
Beatus vir qui implevit desiderium suum ex ipsis:
non confundetur cum loquetur
inimicis suis in porta.
Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

15 Trinitatem venerata e corporis ergastulo discedens
ad caeleste regnum evolavit. Alleluia.

16 Lauda Jerusalem Dominum: Lauda Deum tuum Sion.
Quoniam confortavit seras portarum tuarum:
benedixit filiis tuis in te.
Qui posuit fines tuos pacem: et adipe frumenti satiat te.
Qui emittit eloquium suum terrae:
velociter currit sermo eius. Qui dat nivem sicut lanam:
nebulam sicut cinerem spargit.
Mittit crystallum suum sicut buccellas:
ante faciem frigoris eius quis sustinebit?
Emittit verbum suum, et liquefaciet ea:
flabit spiritus eius, et fluent aquae.
Qui annuntiat verbum suum Jacob: iustitias et iudicia sua Israel.
Non fecit taliter omni nationi:
et iudicia sua non manifestavit eis.
Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

and he said to me: Arise up my love and come away,
for lo, the winter is past, the rains are over and gone,
and the flowers appear in our land. The time of pruning is nigh.

Firm in her confession of the Holy Trinity,
she was freed from all torments by the mercy of God. Alleluia.

Except the Lord build the house,
their labour is but vain that build it.
Except the Lord keep the city, the watchman wakes in vain.
It is lost labour that ye haste to rise up early:
and so take rest late, and eat the bread of carefulness,
for so he gives his beloved sleep.
Lo, children and fruit of the womb
are a heritage and gift that come of the Lord.
Like arrows in the hand of a giant, so are the young children.
Happy is the man that hath his quiver full of them:
he shall not be ashamed when he speaks
with his enemies in the gate.
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.

After worshipping the Trinity, she left the prison of this mortal body
and took wing to the kingdom of heaven. Alleluia.

Praise the Lord, O Jerusalem: praise thy God, O Sion.
For He hath made fast the bars of thy gates:
hath blessed thy children within thee. He makes peace
in thy borders: and fills thee with the flour of wheat.
He sends forth His commandment upon earth
and His word runs swiftly. He gives snow like wool:
and scatters the hoar-frost like ashes.
He casts forth his ice like morsels:
who is able to abide His frost?
He sends out His word, and melts them:
His breath blows, and the waters flow.
He shows his word unto Jacob: His statutes and laws unto Israel.
He has not dealt so with any nation:
neither have the heathen knowledge of His laws.
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.

- 17 Duo Seraphim clamabant** alter ad alterum:
Sanctus Dominus Deus Sabaoth.
Plena est omnis terra gloria eius.
Tres sunt, qui testimonium dant in caelo:
Pater, Verbum et Spiritus Sanctus. Et hi tres unum sunt.
Sanctus Dominus Deus Sabaoth.
Plena est omnis terra gloria eius.

COMPACT DISC 2

- 1 Confitebor tibi Domine** Rex, et collaudabo te
Deum salvatorem meum: confitebor nomini tuo:
quoniam adiutor, et protector factus es mihi,
et liberasti corpus meum a perditione. Deo gratias.

- 2 Exultet celebres virginis** inclite
laudes commemorans turbe fidelium,
succinique modis nomen et ardui
palmarum martyrii contentent alacriter.

In patris valida turris Dioscori
tres mandat speculas Barbara confici;
arrepta genitor cuspidis ferrea natae
prosequitur terga trementia.

Vincitur, praemittitur, verberare tristitia fert
tormenta nigro carcere clauduntur:
constanter fidei mystica disserit
damnatur capitis sancta iuvencla.

Dextra caesa patris per radiantia
caeli stelliferi culmina permeat
crudelisque pater sanguine filiae
pollutus rupido fulgure concidit.

Trino unique Deo saecula per omnia
sit virtus et honor et pia gloria;
optatam famulis qui sine termino
vitam sideris donat in atriis. Amen.

- 3 Ora pro nobis** beata Barbara.
Ut digni efficiamus promissionibus Christi.

- 4 Hodie beata Barbara virgo gloriosa**
patris sui monitis ac mundi vanitatibus spretis
pro Christi amore corruptibili vita se abdicans

*The two Seraphim cried one to another:
'Holy is the Lord God of Sabaoth.
The whole earth is full of His glory:
there are three that bear record in heaven:
the Father, the Word and the Holy Ghost, and these three are one.
Holy is the Lord God of Sabaoth:
the whole earth is full of His glory.*

*I will bear witness to You, Lord and King, and I will praise You,
God my saviour. I will confess Your name,
for You are my help and protection,
and have freed my body from death. Thanks be to God.*

*Let all the faithful now repeat with joy,
the high praises of this holy maid,
and with the aid of music let them eagerly
sing her name, and the glories of her martyr's fate.*

*In the mighty tower of her father Dioscurus,
Barbara ordered triple windows made,
but he snatched up his iron sword
and pursued his daughter as she fled in fear.*

*She was captured, bound, torments she bore
and grievous flogging as she lay in her dark prison:
but faithfully she preached the mysteries of faith,
until this holy girl met her harsh end.*

*Slain by her father's hand, she passed on
to the shining heights of starry heaven,
and the cruel father stained with a child's blood,
was soon struck down by a lightning flash.*

*To God the Three in One for evermore
be glory and honour and loving praise,
who ever grants to those that serve Him their hope
of everlasting life in the courts of heaven. Amen.*

*Pray for us, O blessed Barbara,
that we be made worthy of the promises of Christ.*

*This day the blessed Barbara, the glorious virgin,
rejected the orders of her father and the world's empty promises;
giving up this corruptible life for the love of Christ,*

ad incorruptibilem perpetuo
cum Christo regnatura descendit. Alleluia.

- 5 Magnificat** anima mea Dominum.
Et exultavit spiritus meus in Deo salutari meo.
Quia respexit humilitatem ancillae suae:
ecce enim ex hoc beatam me
dicent omnes generationes.
Quia fecit mihi magna qui potens est:
et sanctum nomen eius. Et misericordia eius
a progenie in progenies timentibus eum.
Fecit potentiam in brachio suo:
dispersit superbos mente cordis sui.
Deposuit potentes de sede
et exaltavit humiles.
Esurientes implevit bonis:
et divites dimisit inanes.
Suscepit Israel puerum suum, recordatus misericordiae suae.
Sicut locutus est ad patres nostros,
Abraham et semini eius in saecula.
Gloria Patri et Filio et Spiritui Sancto:
Sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper,
et in saecula saeculorum. Amen.

- 6 Dominus vobiscum.** Et cum spiritu tuo. Oremus.
Deus, cuius delectionem beata Barbara
omni terreno amore anteposuit:
praesta quaesumus, ut cuius martyrii
triumphum hodierna die recolimus:
eius patrocinio ad caelesta regna pervenire possimus.
Per Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum
Filium tuum, qui tecum vivit et regnat
in unitate Spiritus Sancti Deus
per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen.
Dominus vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo.
Benedicamus Domino. Deo gratias.

- 7 Gaude Barbara beata,**
summe pollens in doctrina angeli mysterio.
Gaude virgo Deo grata,
quae Baptistam imitata es in vitae stadio.
Gaude, cum te visitavit

she ascended to heaven to share for evermore in the
kingdom of Christ in the life incorruptible. Alleluia.

*My soul doth magnify the Lord.
And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour.
For He hath regarded the lowliness of His handmaiden:
for behold from henceforth
all generations shall call me blessed.
For He that is mighty hath magnified me:
holy is His name. And His mercy is on them that fear Him
throughout all generations.
He hath showed strength with His arm:
He hath scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.
He hath put down the mighty from their seat:
and hath exalted the humble.
He hath filled the hungry with good things:
and the rich He hath sent empty away.
He remembering His mercy hath holpen His servant Israel.
As He promised to our forefathers,
Abraham and his seed for ever.
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost:
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen.*

*The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Let us pray.
O God, whose love the blessed Barbara
put before all earthly affection;
grant, we pray, that as we recall today
her triumphant martyrdom, we may also be able,
as her heirs, to come to the Kingdom of heaven at last.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ
your Son, who lives and reigns with you
in the unity of the Holy Ghost,
one God for ever and ever. Amen.
The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit.
Let us bless the Lord. Thanks be to God.*

*Rejoice, O blessed Barbara, most highly versed
in holy learning by the angel's mystic teaching.
Rejoice, O virgin loved of God,
who emulates the Baptist in the struggle of your life.
Rejoice, for Christ came to you while you*

Christus vita et curavit plagas actu proprio.
Gaude, quia meruisti
impetrare quod petisti, dante Dei Filio.
Gaude, namque elevata es
in caela, et velata nobili martyrio.
Te laudantem familiam
trahe post te ad gloriam finito exilio.
O Barbara tam decora, pro nobis Christum exora.

8 Sit nomen Domini benedictum

ex hoc, nunc et usque in saeculum.
Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini
qui fecit caelum et terram.
Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus,
Pater et Filius et Spiritus Sanctus. Amen.
Fidelium animae per misericordiam Dei
requiescant in pace. Amen.

9 Audi caelum verba mea,

plena desiderio et perfusa gaudio ... (audio)
Dic, quaeso, mihi: Quae es ista, quae consurgens
ut aurora rutilat ut benedicam? ... (dicam?)
Dic nam ista pulchra ut luna, electa
ut sol, replet laetitia terras,
caelos, maria ... (maria)
Maria virgo illa dulcis, praedicata
de propheta Ezechiel porta orientalis ... (talis)
Illa sacra et felix porta, per quem mors
fuit expulsa, introduxit autem vita ... (ita)
quae semper tutum est medium
inter homines et Deum, pro culpis remedium ... (medium).
Omnes hanc ergo sequamur quia cum gratia
mereamur vitam aeternam consequamur ... (sequamur)
Praestat nobis Deus, Pater hoc et Filius
et Mater cuius nomen invocamus dulce
miseris solamen ... (Amen).
Benedicta es, virgo Maria, in saeculorum saecula.

10 Angelus Domini nuntiavit Mariae.

Et concepit de Spiritu Sancto. Oremus.
Omnipotens sempiterna Deus,
qui gloriosae virginis matris Mariae
corpus et animam ut dignum filii tui

*yet lived and healed your wounds by his own hand.
Rejoice, for you were found worthy to obtain the
answer to your prayers from the hand of God's Son.
Rejoice, for you have been raised to highest heaven
and are clothed in the glory of noble martyrdom.
See your servants sing your praises and bring
them with you into glory after this our exile here.
O most gracious Barbara, make your prayer to Christ for us.*

*Blessed be the name of the Lord
from this time forth and for evermore.
Our help is in the name of the Lord,
who made heaven and earth.
May Almighty God bless you,
the Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen.
May the souls of the faithful departed,
through the mercy of God rest in peace. Amen.*

*Heaven hear my words
full of desire and suffused with joy ... (I hear)
Tell me: who is she who rises bright
as the dawn, that I may bless her? ... (I will say)
Say, for she is beautiful, chosen as the moon,
like the sun fills the earth,
the heavens and the seas with joy ... (Mary)
The sweet Virgin Mary, foretold by the prophet
Ezechiel, the portal of the East? ... (such is she)
This holy and happy portal through which death
was driven out and life brought to us? ... (thus it is)
who is ever the perfect and sure link
between God and man, remedy for sin? ... (She is that link)
Let us all therefore follow her by whose grace
we may deserve eternal life ... (let us follow)
God the Father grant us this, and the Son
and the Mother on whose name we call
as sweet solace to the sorrowful ... (Amen).
Blessed are you, O Virgin Mary, world without end.*

*The angel of the Lord declared unto Mary.
And she conceived by the Holy Ghost. Let us pray.
Almighty and everlasting God, who made ready,
by the power of the Holy Ghost, the body and soul
of Mary, the glorious and ever-virgin Mother,*

habitu ac effluui mereretur Spiritu Sancto
cooperante praeparasti:
da, ut cuius commemoratione laetemur,
eius pia intercessione, ab instantibus malis,
et a morte perpetua liberemur,
et famulos tuos ab omni
adversitate custodi.
Per eundem Christum Dominum nostrum. Amen.

11 Sancta Barbara, ora pro nobis.

The item which follows forms no part of the Santa Barbara liturgy but has been recorded in order to represent the complete 1610 Vespers music.

12 Ave maris stella,

Dei mater alma,
Atque semper virgo,
Felix caeli porta.

Sumens illud Ave
Gabrielis ore,
Funda nos in pace,
Mutans nomen Hevae.

Solve vincla reis,
Profer lumen caecis,
Mala nostra pelle,
Bona cuncta posce.

Monstra te esse matrem:
Sumat per te precem,
Qui pro nobis natus,
Tulit esse tuus.

Virgo singularis,
Inter omnes mitis,
Nos culpis solutos,
Mites fac et castos.

Vitam praesta puram,
Iter para tutum,
Ut videntes Jesum,
Semper collaetemur.

Sit laus Deo Patri,
Summo Christo decus,
Spiritui Sancto,
Tribus honor unus. Amen.

*that she might be worthy to become
a dwelling place fit for your Son;
grant that as we rejoice in this her commemoration,
we may by her kind intercession be made
free from all the evils which surround us,
and from everlasting death. and that
thy servants be guarded from all adversity.
Through the one Christ our Lord. Amen.*

Saint Barbara, pray for us.

*Hail, star of the sea,
merciful mother of God,
ever a virgin,
happy door of heaven.

Receiving this 'Ave'
from the mouth of Gabriel,
bring us to peace,
reversing the name 'Eva'.

Unbind the shackles of the accused,
bring light to the blind,
take away our misfortunes
and bring us every good.

Show yourself as mother;
may he who was yours,
born for us,
receive our prayer through you.

Unique virgin,
gentler than all,
make us gentle and chaste,
free from the bonds of sin.

Bring us a pure life,
prepare the true way,
so that, seeing Jesus,
we may rejoice for ever.

Let there be praise to God the father,
honour to Christ on high,
to the Holy Ghost,
to all three one honour. Amen.*

MONTEVERDI Secondes vêpres pour la fête de Santa Barbara

LES VÊPRES de 1610 de Monteverdi recèlent quelques-unes des musiques les mieux connues de toute la période baroque, mais leur auteur ne semble avoir laissé aucune indication quant à l'occasion pour laquelle elles furent composées. En fait, ces pièces furent probablement écrites individuellement et nous n'en faisons un tout que parce qu'elles furent en fin de compte publiées comme tel. De ces vêpres, nous savons seulement qu'elles furent écrites pendant que Monteverdi était au service du duc de Mantoue, puis publiées alors qu'il se sentait sous-estimé par la famille Gonzaga et cherchait du travail ailleurs.

La présente reconstruction résulte d'une nouvelle hypothèse concernant les circonstances de composition de cette œuvre, hypothèse que j'argumentai in extenso dans un article d'*Early Music* paru en août 1987. Depuis toujours intrigué par certains aspects de l'agencement de ces Vêpres, j'entrepris de nouvelles recherches, sans jamais perdre de vue la situation mantouane durant l'activité de Monteverdi. L'inclusion d'une mise en musique de *Duo Seraphim* m'avait toujours semblé particulièrement problématique, avec son texte qui débute sur une description des séraphins criant l'un à l'autre autour du trône de Dieu pour s'achever sur une ferme énonciation de la foi en la doctrine de la Trinité. L'énonciation de ce dogme est évidemment fondamentale pour la pensée chrétienne mais n'a que peu à voir avec la célébration des fêtes de la Vierge Marie. D'où la discordance depuis toujours constatée entre le texte trinitaire de cette pièce et la page de titre de la publication.

Tous ces éléments m'amènèrent à me demander si la dédicace à la Vierge figurant dans la publication de 1610 pouvait ne pas refléter pleinement l'intention originelle cachée derrière la musique contenue dans ce volume. Les institutions religieuses italiennes tendaient, en effet, à privilégier la célébration de saints et de festivals locaux au détriment des observances traditionnelles de l'Eglise toute entière. À Mantoue, et particulièrement à la maison Gonzaga, employeur

de Monteverdi, une sainte prévalait : Santa Barbara, patronne de la famille Gonzaga et sainte de la basilique sise sur le domaine palatial. Sa beauté rare lui ayant valu d'être emprisonnée dans une tour durant l'absence de son père, Barbara, qui s'était convertie au christianisme, demanda aux ouvriers de l'œuvre sur sa tour de percer une troisième fenêtre en l'honneur de la Trinité. Elle fut finalement martyrisée pour sa foi chrétienne. De par son fort accent trinitaire, le texte de *Duo Seraphim* concorde bien avec la célébration de la fête de Santa Barbara et, de fait, deux des antienne chantées à la basilique lors des Secondes vêpres le jour de la sainte font référence à la doctrine trinitaire.

Chaque année, le 4 décembre, sa fête était célébrée dans la basilique ducale avec force solennité. La préface d'un recueil de musique publié en 1613 par un compositeur mantouan ultérieur, Amante Franzoni, indique que de la musique instrumentale était régulièrement entendue ce jour-là. Cette célébration devait être d'une grande importance politique pour les Gonzaga, car honorer dignement leur patronne leur permettait d'attirer l'attention sur leur propre prestige de dynastie régnante. Le recueil de Franzoni susmentionné comporte une mise en musique de *Duo Seraphim* destinée à ce jour de fête, preuve que ce texte occupait une place définie dans les arrangements musicaux interprétés lors des célébrations. Et il paraîtrait étrange que cette musique, la plus élaborée de la cour mantouane de cette époque, ne fût pas employée lors de la fête de la sainte la plus vénérée.

Selon toute probabilité, le service s'ouvrirait sur une adaptation de la toccata de *L'Orfeo*, une fanfare qui semble avoir revêtu une importance cérémoniale particulière pour la famille Gonzaga. Puis, la famille régnante s'assemblerait pour les vêpres en l'honneur de la sainte qu'elle considérait comme sa protectrice, au son de la demande initiale de l'aide de Dieu, chantée sur une musique symbole de son pouvoir.

Un examen de la liturgie propre à la basilique ducale révèle

que les psaumes utilisés pour les secondes vêpres de Santa Barbara correspondent exactement à ceux mis en musique par Monteverdi. Mais l'absence de preuves invalide toute affirmation selon laquelle ces psaumes auraient tous été composés comme un cycle destiné à une célébration spécifique. Leur écriture aurait en effet fort bien pu s'étaler sur une période plus longue, au cours de laquelle ils se seraient substitués au chant liturgique normal pour ajouter de la magnificence aux célébrations. La liturgie propre à la basilique ducale était le fruit du conservatisme de la Contre-Réforme, et il se pourrait que Monteverdi inclût des chants dans les mises en musique psalmiques—ce qui était tout à fait inhabituel—afin de préserver l'éthos culturel traditionnel.

Les textes *Pulchra es* et *Nigra sum*, extraits du *Cantique des Cantiques*, sont applicables non seulement aux fêtes de la Vierge mais aux célébrations de toute sainte. Aussi auraient-ils pu être associés à la fête de Santa Barbara comme à la Vierge Marie. Les seules pièces supplémentaires (outre celles appropriées pour Santa Barbara) sont *Audi caelum* et *Ave maris stella*. Cette dernière hymne, qui utilise la forme romaine du chant et non celle de Santa Barbara, n'était pas expressément destinée à la basilique ducale, et son inclusion dans le présent enregistrement vise à représenter complètement la musique des Vêpres, telle que publiée en 1610.

La *Sonate sopra Sancta Maria* soulève, pourrait-on penser, quelques problèmes, mais nous avons la preuve que des pièces liturgiques de cette nature étaient fréquemment adaptées pour insérer le nom du saint dont c'était la fête. Dans des exemples similaires, le nom du saint est laissé en blanc ou son emplacement est marqué d'un « N », et des rubriques ad hoc sont fournies (telles « Ce motet convient à tout saint, masculin ou féminin »). Peut-être la sonate de Monteverdi fut-elle originellement composée en pensant à Marie, mais l'usage de l'époque nous montre que la substitution d'un saint à un autre était une pratique courante. Dans la présente reconstruction, le nom de Barbara remplace celui de Marie et le rythme bien connu a été ajusté en conséquence.

Deux brèves sonates instrumentales, extraites d'un manuscrit compilé en 1613 par le musicien mantouan Giovanni Amigone, servent de substituts d'antennes. Ces pièces, dont rien ne certifie qu'Amigone les composât en personne, figurent assurément parmi les toute premières sonates pour un seul instrument soprano et continuo.

Nous savons que Monteverdi n'occupa aucune position officielle à la basilique ducale, qui employait son propre personnel et était indépendante de l'établissement musical profane de la cour. Cette séparation des fonctions explique certainement la faible quantité de musique d'église produite par Monteverdi durant le temps passé au service de la famille Gonzaga. Dans les années qui suivirent *L'Orfeo*, l'église ducale connut une période d'instabilité consécutive à la maladie du *maestro* et à l'absence d'un remplaçant satisfaisant. La famille put alors très bien passer outre ses propres structures administratives et ordonner à son plus célèbre musicien d'aider au maintien des normes musicales de la chapelle. En fait, la mention « chapelles princières » de la page de titre de la publication de 1610 pourrait même être considérée comme fallacieuse si les œuvres n'avaient jamais été exécutées à la chapelle attachée au palais où Monteverdi avait si longtemps travaillé.

Pourquoi Monteverdi décida-t-il de publier des Vêpres « della Beata Vergine » plutôt que de faire allusion aux origines des œuvres dans une dédicace à Santa Barbara—si tant est que la fête de cette sainte se cache réellement derrière cette composition ? À l'heure de la publication du volume de 1610, ses relations avec la dynastie des Gonzaga s'étaient dégradées et Monteverdi, en quête d'un nouveau poste, devait prouver ses compétences de compositeur. Or, publier un volume destiné aux vêpres de Santa Barbara aurait suscité peu d'intérêt, car aucune autre institution ne célébrait cette fête aussi dispendieusement. Un tel geste aurait, en outre, renforcé énormément le prestige de la famille qui l'avait injustement traité. La musique était en si grande partie interchangeable que publier le volume avec une dédicace mariale

ne posait aucun problème, d'autant que le nombre d'institutions consacrées à la Vierge aurait assuré un important marché. Sur la page de titre, Monteverdi n'en utilise pas moins à son propre avantage ses rapports avec les Gonzaga, en précisant que sa musique convient aux « Sacella sive

Principum Cubicula »—aux chapelles et chambres princières. Les œuvres constitutives de ce volume peuvent fort bien tirer leurs origines des célébrations en l'honneur de la sainte à laquelle la chapelle princièrè mantouane était consacrée—Santa Barbara.

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Traduction HYPERION

MONTEVERDI Zweite Vesper zum Fest der Heiligen Barbara

MONTEVERDIS im Jahre 1610 komponierte Vesper enthält Musikstücke, die zu den bekanntesten der gesamten barocken Ära gehören, doch scheint es, als habe der Komponist kein Anzeichen dafür hinterlassen, zu welchem Anlaß diese Stücke komponiert wurden. In der Tat könnte man leicht annehmen, daß diese Stücke individuell entstanden, und von uns nur als Gruppe empfunden werden, weil sie schließlich als solche veröffentlicht wurden. Mit Sicherheit wissen wir nur, daß die Vespermusik entstand, als Monteverdi sich im Dienste des Herzogs von Mantua befand; sie wurde zu einer Zeit veröffentlicht, in der er sich als von der Familie Gonzaga zu gering eingeschätzt empfand und nach einer anderweitigen Stellung Ausschau hielt.

Die hier präsentierte Rekonstruktion ist das Ergebnis einer neuen, die Umstände der Komposition betreffenden Hypothese, die ich in einem im August 1987 in der Zeitschrift *Early Music* gedruckten Artikel ausführlich dargelegt habe. Einige Aspekte der Zusammenstellung des Bandes von Vespermusik waren mir immer als sehr merkwürdig erschienen, und ich begann daher, Nachforschungen anzustellen, und dabei die Situation in Mantua während Monteverdis dortiger Tätigkeit in Betracht zu ziehen. Die Tatsache, daß ein Satz von *Duo Seraphim* in den Band aufgenommen wurde, war immer als besonders problematisch erschienen: der Text dieses Stückes beginnt mit einer Beschreibung der Seraphim, wie sie um Gottes Thron

stehen und einander zurufen, und schließt mit einer Bekräftigung des Glaubens an die Lehre von der Dreieinigkeit. Ganz sicherlich ist eine Darlegung dieses Dogmas von grundlegender Bedeutung innerhalb des christlichen Denkens, doch hat sie wenig mit der Begehung der Festtage der Jungfrau Maria zu tun. Es schien immer, als befände sich der trinitarische Text dieses Musikstückes im Widerspruch zur Titelseite des Druckwerkes.

Ich stellte mir daher die Frage, ob die Widmung der Veröffentlichung von 1610 an die Jungfrau Maria vielleicht der ursprünglichen Intention der in dem Band enthaltenen Musik keinen vollständigen Ausdruck verleiht. Die religiösen Einrichtungen Italiens neigten dazu, die Feier örtlicher Heiliger und Festtage stärker zu betonen als jene religiösen Oberservanzen, die Allgemeinbesitz der geamten Kirche waren. In Mantua, und insbesondere im Haushalt der Gonzagas, in dem Monteverdi beschäftigt war, hatte eine Heilige, nämlich Sankt Barbara, den Vorrang vor allen anderen; sie war die Schutzpatronin der Familie Gonzaga, und die im Gelände des Palasts erbaute Basilika war ihr geweiht. Aufgrund ihrer außergewöhnlichen Schönheit war Barbara während der Abwesenheit ihres Vaters in einem Turm gefangengehalten worden; sie wurde zum Christentum bekehrt und bat daraufhin die Maurer, die an ihrem Turm arbeiteten, zu Ehren der Dreieinigkeit ein drittes Fenster hinzuzufügen. Schließlich erlitt sie dann aufgrund ihres

christlichen Glaubens den Märtyrertod. Der Text von *Duo Seraphim* mit seiner starken Hervorhebung der Trinität fügt sich gut in die Feier des Festtages der Heiligen Barbara ein, und in der Tat beziehen sich zwei der beim zweiten Abendgottesdienst an ihrem Festtag in der Basilika gesungenen Antiphonen auf die Lehre von der Dreieinigkeit.

In jedem Jahr wurde ihr Fest am 4. Dezember in der herzoglichen Basilika mit großer Feierlichkeit begangen. Das Vorwort zu einer 1613 von Amante Franzoni, einem späteren, ebenfalls in Mantua ansässigen Komponisten veröffentlichten Musiksammlung deutet an, daß Instrumentalmusik an jenem Tag regelmäßig gehört wurde. Für die Familie Gonzaga wäre dies eine Feier von großer politischer Bedeutung gewesen, da sie in der Ehrerbietung für ihre Schutzpatronin Aufmerksamkeit auf ihr eigenes Ansehen als herrschende Dynastie lenkte. Franzonis Sammlung von 1613 enthält einen Satz von *Duo Seraphim*, der für diesen Festtag intendiert war, und dies zeigt, daß der Text einen festen Platz innerhalb der während der Feierlichkeiten vorgetragenen Musiksätze hatte. Es wäre merkwürdig, wenn die anspruchsvollste Musik, die in diesem Zeitalter am Hof von Mantua in Erscheinung trat, nicht am Fest einer Heiligen benutzt würde, die mehr Verehrung als jede andere erfuhr.

Der Gottesdienst wurde wahrscheinlich mit einer Adaption der Toccata aus *L'Orfeo* eingeleitet, also mit einer Fanfare, die anscheinend für die Familie Gonzaga besondere zeremonielle Bedeutung besaß. So hörte die fürstliche Familie den einleitenden Ruf nach Gottes Hilfe zu einer ihre eigene Macht symbolisierenden Musik gesungen, wenn sie sich zum Abendgottesdienst versammelte, um jene Heilige zu verehren, die sie als ihre Schutzherrin empfand.

Eine Untersuchung der in der herzoglichen Basilika gebräuchlichen Musik zeigt, daß die zur Zweiten Vesper der Heiligen Barbara benutzten Psalmen genau mit den von Monteverdi vertonten übereinstimmen. Da es kaum Anzeichen hierfür gibt, ist es sinnlos, zu behaupten, daß alle diese Psalmen als Zyklus anlässlich einer besonderen Feier kom-

pониert wurden. In der Tat könnten sie gut im Laufe einer längeren Zeit vertont worden sein, um kirchlichen Feiern dadurch Glanz zu verleihen, daß sie anstelle des normalen Gesangs oder der Liturgie verwendet wurden. Die besondere Liturgie der herzoglichen Basilika war das Produkt eines gegenreformatorischen Konservatismus, und es könnte daher gut möglich sein, daß Monteverdi den ungewöhnlichen Weg einschlug, Gesänge in die Psalmvertonungen aufzunehmen, um auf diese Weise das dort gewürdigte traditionelle Ethos des Gottesdienstes zu bewahren.

Die Texte aus dem *Hohenlied*, nämlich *Pulchra es* und *Nigra sum* eignen sich nicht lediglich zum Gebrauch an Festtagen der Jungfrau Maria, sondern auch an Festtagen jeder anderen Heiligen; sie könnten mit dem Fest der Heiligen Barbara genauso gut in Verbindung gestanden haben wie mit den die Jungfrau Maria umgebenden Feierlichkeiten. Die einzigen zusätzlichen Musikstücke (die über die für Sankt Barbara geeigneten hinausgehen) sind *Audi caelum* und *Ave maris stella*. In *Ave maris stella* wird die römische und nicht die Sankt Barbara eigene Gesangsform benutzt, und dieses Stück war daher nicht ausdrücklich für die herzogliche Basilika vorgesehen; es wurde jedoch in diese Aufzeichnung aufgenommen, um die 1610 im Druck erschienene Verspermusik vollständig zu repräsentieren.

Die *Sonata sopra Sancta Maria* könnte als problematisch empfunden werden, doch gibt es Anzeichen dafür, daß liturgische Stücke dieser Art oft adaptiert wurden, um den Namen des Heiligen, dessen Festtag es war, einzubeziehen. In ähnlichen Beispielen wird der Name des Heiligen offengelassen, oder sein Platz ist mit einem „N“ markiert, und passende liturgische Anweisungen werden geliefert (zum Beispiel „Diese Motette eignet sich für jeden beliebigen Heiligen, männlich oder weiblich“). Vielleicht wurde Monteverdis Sonate ursprünglich im Gedenken an die Jungfrau Maria komponiert, doch war es zu jener Zeit allgemein gebräuchlich, eine Heilige durch eine andere zu ersetzen. In dieser Rekonstruktion steht der Name Barbara anstelle von Maria, und der

gewohnte Rhythmus wurde dementsprechend angepaßt.

Zwei kurze Instrumentalsonaten dienen als Ersatz für Antiphonen. Diese wurden einem 1613 von dem in Mantua ansässigen Musiker Giovanni Amigone zusammengestellten Manuskript entnommen. Es läßt sich nicht mit Gewißheit sagen, ob Amigone selbst der Komponist war, doch zählen die Musikstücke sicherlich zu den frühesten Solosonaten für Sopraninstrument und Continuo.

Wir wissen, daß Monteverdi keine offizielle Stellung in der herzoglichen Basilika bekleidete, da diese ihr eigenes Personal beschäftigte und unabhängig von den weltlichen musikalischen Einrichtungen des Hofes fungierte. Diese Trennung von Funktionen ist sicher ein Grund für die karge Menge von Kirchenmusik, die Monteverdi während seiner Zeit im Dienste der Familie Gonzaga hervorbrachte. Während der auf *L'Orfeo* folgenden Jahre erteilt die herzogliche Kirche eine unsichere Zeit, in welcher der maestro erkrankte und kein befriedigender Ersatz gefunden wurde. Es mag gut sein, daß die Familie während eines solchen Zeitabschnitts ihre eigenen Verwaltungsstrukturen dadurch außer Kraft setzte, daß sie ihrem berühmtesten Musiker den Auftrag verlieh, dabei zu helfen, die Qualität der in der Kapelle gespielten Musik aufrechtzuerhalten. In der Tat könnte man sogar die Erwähnung von „fürstlichen Kapellen“ auf der Titelseite des 1610 veröffentlichten Bandes als irreführend betrachten, wenn diese Werke nie in der zum Palast gehörigen Kapelle, in der Monteverdi so lange gearbeitet hatte, aufgeführt worden wären.

Warum entschied sich Monteverdi dazu, eine Vesper „della Beata Vergine“ zu veröffentlichen, und nicht in einer Widmung für Sankt Barbara auf den Ursprung der Werke hinzuweisen, wenn ihr Festtag tatsächlich der Anlaß zu dieser Komposition war? Als Monteverdi den Band von 1610 veröffentlichte, hatte sich seine Beziehung zum Fürstenhaus der Gonzagas bereits verschlechtert. Er hielt Ausschau nach einer anderweitigen Stellung und mußte seine kompositorischen Fähigkeiten beweisen. Hätte er einen für die Vesper der Heiligen Barbara vorgesehenen Musikband veröffentlicht, so hätte er hiermit nur geringes Interesse erzeugt: keine andere Institution feierte dieses Fest so überschwänglich. Überdies hätte er einer Familie, die ihn ungerecht behandelt hatte, zu weiterem enormen Ansehen verholfen. Ein so großer Teil der Musik war austauschbar, daß es kein Problem für Monteverdi darstellte, die Musik mit einer marianischen Widmung zu veröffentlichen: die Anzahl der religiösen Einrichtungen, die der Jungfrau geweiht waren, hätten ihm einen guten Absatzmarkt für seine Musik garantiert. Doch benutzt Monteverdi auf der Titelseite des Bandes seine Verbindung zu den Gonzagas zu seinem eigenen Vorteil: er bemerkt dort nämlich, daß die Musik sich zum Vortrag in „*Sacella sive Principum Cubicula*“—den Kapellen und Kammern von Fürsten—eignet. Die den Band ausmachenden Werke mögen ihren Ursprung gut den Festlichkeiten zu Ehren der Heiligen, der die fürstliche Kapelle in Mantua geweiht war, verdanken—nämlich Sankt Barbara.

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Second Vespers for the Feast of Santa Barbara

COMPACT DISC 1

[53'30]

1	ORGAN IMPROVISATION	[1'07]
2	<i>Chant</i> Deus in adiutorium meum intende	[1'59]
3	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> Angelicam vitam eligens	[0'38]
4	PSALM Dixit Dominus Domino meo	[7'37]
5	ANTIPHON SUBSTITUTE Pulchra es, amica mea	[3'51]
6	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> In Dei orto sata	[0'30]
7	PSALM Laudate pueri Dominum	[6'20]
8	ANTIPHON SUBSTITUTE Giovanni Amigone (?) Sonata	[1'31]
9	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> Paterni oblita amoris	[0'37]
10	PSALM Laetatus sum in his	[7'12]
11	ANTIPHON SUBSTITUTE Nigra sum, sed formosa	[4'14]
12	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> In Sanctae Trinitatis	[0'34]
13	PSALM Nisi Dominus aedificaverit domum	[4'46]
14	ANTIPHON SUBSTITUTE Giovanni Amigone (?) Sonata	[1'13]
15	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> Trinitatem venerata	[0'31]
16	PSALM Lauda Jerusalem	[4'45]
17	ANTIPHON SUBSTITUTE Duo Seraphim clamabant	[5'56]

COMPACT DISC 2

[55'27]

1	CHAPTER <i>Chant</i> Confitebor tibi Domine	[0'35]
2	HYMN <i>Chant</i> Exultet celebres virginis	[2'16]
3	RESPONSE <i>Chant</i> Ora pro nobis	[0'18]
4	ANTIPHON <i>Chant</i> Hodie beata Barbara virgo gloriosa	[1'00]
5	MAGNIFICAT Magnificat anima mea	[17'55]
6	<i>Chant</i> Dominus vobiscum	[1'38]
7	MOTET Giovanni Pierluigi da Palestrina Gaude Barbara beata	[7'43]
8	BLESSING <i>Chant</i> Sit nomen Domini benedictum	[0'51]
9	SUBSTITUTE FOR MARIAN ANTIPHON Audi caelum verba mea	[8'04]
10	RESPONSE/COLLECT <i>Chant</i> Angelus Domini nunciavit Mariae	[1'16]
11	SONATA Sancta Barbara, ora pro nobis	[6'23]
12	HYMN Ave maris stella	[7'22]

THE SIXTEEN CHOIR AND ORCHESTRA
HARRY CHRISTOPHERS conductor

NOTES EN FRANÇAIS + MIT DEUTSCHEM KOMMENTAR

'Unique and valuable. This will rank as one of Harry Christophers' proudest moments on disc and I urge you to put it next to any other recording you have' (*Fanfare*, USA)

CLAUDIO MONTEVERDI (1567–1643)

VESPERS

for the Feast of Santa Barbara
(reconstructed by Graham Dixon)

Secondes vêpres pour la fête de Santa Barbara

Zweite Vesper zum Fest der Heiligen Barbara

This recording of Monteverdi's Vespers presents the work as it was probably first heard at the Court of the Duke of Mantua. It contains many extra chants, a motet by Palestrina, and some instrumental sonatas, possibly by Amigone.

THE SIXTEEN CHOIR AND ORCHESTRA
HARRY CHRISTOPHERS conductor

Recorded in All Hallows, Gospel Oak, on 28–30 March 1988
Recording Engineer ANTONY HOWELL
Recording Producer MARK BROWN
Executive Producers STEUART HAMILTON, EDWARD PERRY
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Front illustration: *St Barbara fleeing from her father*
by Sir Peter Paul Rubens (1577–1640)
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2 compact discs
CDD22028
Duration 108'57

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MADE IN ENGLAND

THE SIXTEEN CHOIR AND ORCHESTRA

Soloists

soprano 1 Nicola Jenkin *soprano 2* Mary Seers *alto* Christopher Royall
tenor 1 Andrew Murgatroyd *tenor 2* Neil MacKenzie *tenor 3* Mark Padmore
bass 1 Simon Birchall *bass 2* Jeremy White

Choir

sopranos Tessa Bonner, Fiona Clarke, Ruth Dean, Sally Dunkley, Lynne Hirst, Nicola Jenkin, Mary Seers
altos Robin Barda, Peter Hayward, Michael Lees, Christopher Royall
tenors Peter Burrows, Neil MacKenzie, Andrew Murgatroyd, John New, Mark Padmore, Nicolas Robertson
basses Simon Birchall, Lynton Black, Christopher Hodges, Francis Steele, Jeremy White

Schola

Leigh Nixon (celebrant), Simon Birchall, Simon Davies, Andrew Cant
 Philip Lawson, Mark Padmore, Nicolas Robertson, Jeremy White

Orchestra

violins Julie Miller, Catherine Weiss *violas* Jane Compton, Penelope Veryard *cello* Jane Coe
double bass Amanda MacNamara *recorders* Rachel Beckett Marion Scott *dulcian* Andrew Watts
cornets Jeremy West †, Michael Harrison, Robert Farley
sackbuts Paul Beer, Paul Nieman, Robert Hughes *theorbo* Nigel North *organ* Paul Nicholson
 † solo cornet in sonatas

HARRY CHRISTOPHERS conductor

This recording of Monteverdi's *Vespers* presents the work as it was probably first heard at the Court of the Duke of Mantua and includes a motet by Palestrina and two sonatas thought to be by Giovanni Amigone. To hear the work in its more familiar and unexpanded form, derived from its eventual publication under the heading 'della beata Vergine', the tracks should be played in the following order: from disc one, tracks 2, 4, 11, 7, 5, 10, 17 and 13, track 9 from disc two, track 16 from disc one, and then, from disc two, tracks 11, 12 and 5.

Recent research has shown that the clef combinations of *Lauda Jerusalem* and the *Magnificat* indicate a downwards transposition. For this recording these movements are performed at written pitch, since Monteverdi's starting point would probably have been a higher pitch standard than is practicable with the instruments now available. Unless one can adopt this higher basic pitch the character of some parts of these movements is impaired.